

'blood' has been an everlasting symbol in kinship studies. However, kins are decided not just by blood relation (i.e. being) but also by cultural, social relations (i.e. doing).

Unlike Gellner & Turner, who make complete break from structuralism, he retained and modified Levi Strauss ideas of culture as a set of relationships.

Criticisms:

- 1) Criticised for unscientific nature of study
- 2) Marxists: over emphasis on symbols & social realities largely ignore.

Despite criticism, Schneider added a more humanistic & interpretative approach to anthropological study steering away from rigid scientific methods.

5.e) Idea of Oscillating Equilibrium by Edmund Leach

Edmund Leach belongs to the structuralist school of anthropology which considers culture to be an abstract entity engraved in the minds of people.

He gives the idea of oscillating equilibrium to show how ~~between~~ many cultural variables keep moving between opposite ends of the spectrum without being restricted to either.

He demonstrates the same among Kachins of Burma who have two political systems namely Chungking and hereditary and other egalitarian but they choose to stay in Burma system which is an equal combination of both.

Further he also gives a traffic signal study where orange is an equilibrium